ME 200 – THERMODYNAMICS I
COURSE POLICY – FALL 2025

1. **LEARNING OBJECTIVES.** There are four learning objectives associated with this course:
   - To successfully employ the systematic *engineering approach to problem solving*
   - To master applying the *Law of Mass Conservation* when analyzing thermodynamics problems
   - To be proficient in the use of the *1st Law of Thermodynamics* to perform energy accounting when solving thermodynamics problems
   - To be a competent user of the *2nd Law of Thermodynamics* to perform entropy balance when solving thermodynamics problems

2. **TEXTBOOK.** Moran, M. J., Shapiro, H.N., Boettner, D.D., and Bailey, M.B., Fundamentals of Engineering Thermodynamics, Wiley; the 7th, or 8th, or 9th edition is acceptable. However, reading assignments are keyed to the 8th edition. Wiley Plus is not needed. You must use the property tables available on the course site for your division, not those in the textbook, for homework problems.

3. **PREREQUISITES.** The material in ME 200 requires mastery of CHEM 115 and PHYS 172, and includes co-registration in MA 261.

4. **ASSIGNMENTS.** The course schedule is provided as a separate document. It provides a list of topics covered during each class period, the reading to be completed before that class period, as well as the corresponding homework assignments. Note that even if the instructor does not cover every scheduled topic, or may not have time in class to cover all the items, you are still responsible for all the material that is listed in the schedule.

5. **ATTENDANCE.** Attendance and participation in the classroom are expected. However, you should stay home if you are sick or if you suspect you have been in contact with someone who is sick.

6. **HOMEWORK.** Homework problem statements and solutions will be available through the course site for your division. All homework problems must follow the engineering approach provided in a separate document. Homework assignments will be submitted via Gradescope and due by 11:59 p.m. EST on the dates listed in the course schedule. Late homework is never accepted.

7. **EXAMINATIONS.** There are three evening examinations and one comprehensive final examination. All examinations will be on-campus and in-person. All examinations will be closed-book and closed-notes. You must use only TI-30X or TI-36X or Casio-FX-115 or Casio-FX-991 series calculator on all examinations. There will be no exceptions to this requirement. You can read more about this policy at: https://engineering.purdue.edu/ME/Undergraduate/calculatorPolicy. More details for each examination logistics will be provided at least one week prior to the date of the examination. Make-up evening examinations are given only in the case of direct conflict with another exam or in the case of university-approved absences including grief absence, military absence, jury duty absence, and medically excused absence (MEAPS). If you are sick with acceptable medical proof from a physician or nurse practitioner or Purdue University Student Health Services (PUSH), or have an emergency (with proof), or have prior approval from your instructor to miss an evening exam, then contact your instructor. Make-up final examinations are given only in the case of a registered conflict. You must resolve this conflict with your instructor prior to 5 p.m. EST on the last day of the semester.

8. **HELP.** There are several sources of help available outside of class – instructor and teaching assistant office hours, course blog (Piazza), and Supplemental Instruction (SI)/Peer Tutoring sessions. Office hour times and SI/peer tutoring information will be posted on the Brightspace site for your division.

9. **COURSE GRADING.** Your course grade is based on the following algorithm:

Three Evening Examinations (20% each)	60%
Final Examination	25%
Homework	15%

Five lowest homework problem scores (for any reason including medical emergency and other university-registered absences) will be dropped from consideration.

Course grading will not be more stringent than a straight-scale (90 ≤ A+, A, or A-; 80 ≤ B+, B, or B- < 90, etc.). Grade break scores may vary from straight-scale and may be curved at the instructor's discretion.

Regrading requests must be submitted to your instructor within one week of the date the graded document was made available. Prior to submitting a written regrade request, review the posted solutions and then prepare a written justification for the regrade. Regraded items may result in a score that is higher, lower, or the same as compared to the original score.

10. **ACADEMIC INTEGRITY.** Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. You are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value either by emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information that is submitted provides the greatest opportunity for the university to investigate the concern.

When submitting any exam or homework you are adhering to the Purdue Honor Pledge: "As a boilermaker pursuing academic excellence, I pledge to be honest and true in all that I do. Accountable together – we are Purdue". Please see (https://www.purdue.edu/odos/osrr/academic-integrity/index.php) for more information about academic integrity and Purdue's official policy on academic dishonesty.

Any form of academic dishonesty on an exam or homework will result in a grade of zero for that exam or homework, and a letter will be sent to the Dean of Students. After more than one such instance you will receive a failing grade for ME 200 and a letter will be sent to the Dean of Students recommending that you be suspended from Purdue University. Any dishonesty on the final exam will result in a zero for the final exam.

Note that copying homework and/or exams directly from a friend, a file, a solution manual, any online resources (such as Chegg, CourseHero, WeeklyJoys) or AI is cheating. Homework questions are copyrighted materials and therefore you are prohibited from posting them to the internet in any way. While we recognize the benefits of AI in checking work and generating explanations of concepts and approaches to problem-solving, the instructors strongly discourage the use of AI in solving ME 200 homework problems. Using AI creates shortcuts in the process through which you increase your understanding of problems, learn effective problem-solving approaches, and practice setting up and executing solutions. Shortcuts to this (sometimes difficult) process will be significantly detrimental to your full understanding of the course material and inhibit your performance on ME 200 exams.

11. **NONDISCRIMINATION STATEMENT.** Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community which recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her own potential. A hyperlink to Purdue's full Nondiscrimination Policy Statement is included in the Academic Resources table on your Brightspace homepage.

12. **ACCESSIBILITY.** Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center (DRC) at drc@purdue.edu or by phone at 765-494-1247. If the DRC has determined reasonable accommodations that you would like to utilize in this class, you must release your Course Accommodation Letter (CAL) to your instructor. Instructions on sharing your CAL can be found by visiting https://www.purdue.edu/drc/students/course-accommodation-letter.php. Additionally, you are strongly encouraged to contact your instructor as soon as possible to discuss implementation of your accommodations.

    West Lafayette course: Students with disabilities whose DRC CAL includes test accommodations must first release their CAL to their instructor and then schedule to take their exams with Purdue Testing Services at https://www.purdue.edu/studentsuccess/testing-services/accommodated-testing/student.php. You must schedule at least four days (96 hours) before the exam date listed on the syllabus, but earlier is better. In the case of finals week, you must schedule by the Friday before quiet period, and again, earlier is better. The exam will be provided to Purdue Testing Services, and they will proctor it and provide the result to your instructor for grading. Students must inform their instructor immediately of cases when Purdue Testing Services is at capacity or otherwise unable to proctor the exam so that the instructor can make other arrangements. Students who fail to follow this process and meet stated deadlines risk not being able to have their accommodations for that exam.

    Indianapolis course: Students with disabilities whose DRC CAL includes test accommodations must first release their CAL to their instructor and then schedule to take their exams through the DRC in their DRC Student Portal. You must schedule at least two (2) business days before the exam date listed on the syllabus. In the case of finals week, you must schedule by the Friday before quiet period. The exam will be provided to DRC Testing, and they will proctor it and provide the result to your instructor for grading. Students must inform their instructor immediately of cases when DRC Testing is at capacity or otherwise unable to proctor the exam so that the instructor can make other arrangements. Students who fail to follow this process and meet stated deadlines risk not being able to have their accommodation for that exam.

13. **CAMPUS EMERGENCY POLICY.** In the event of a campus emergency, campus emergency procedures (https://www.purdue.edu/ehps/emergency_preparedness/flipchart/index.html) will be followed. The course requirements, deadlines, and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised calendar. You will be informed of such changes by email from the instructor. You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email frequently on a daily basis.

14. **MENTAL HEALTH STATEMENT.** If you are struggling and need mental health services, Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS offices in West Lafayette or Indianapolis.

15. **VIOLENT BEHAVIOR POLICY.** Purdue University is committed to providing a safe and secure campus environment for members of the university community. Purdue strives to create an educational environment for students and a work environment for employees that promote educational and career goals. Violent Behavior impedes such goals. Therefore, violent behavior is prohibited in or on any University Facility or while participating in any university activity.